

grate, update, or photograph well, it's out. Longevity has been replaced by fast paced life choices.

## QUANTUM LEAPS

Money is where the generational difference is widest. Previously, we thought about money incrementally. If our post-tax return beat the fixed deposit rate, we felt clever. A few percentage points here, a bonus there, maybe a second home someday. Wealth was something you accumulated patiently, like silt.

Gen Z thinks in quantum jumps.

They are not interested in beating the system by 2% or even 10%. They invest early, experiment freely, and talk casually about markets our parents still whisper about.

They don't dream of incremental salary hikes. They dream of unicorns. We talk about compounding, they talk about breakouts.

To them, saving ₹50 lakh over 10 years feels almost pointless when they've seen people make or lose that much in a single market swing or start-up exit.

They've watched 22-year-olds join

start-ups that become billion-dollar companies, millionaires appearing overnight, and content creators earning more in a year than executives do in a decade. In that context, incremental thinking feels... quaint.

When Gen Z spends on travel, concerts, or pop-ups, it's not because they're running away from life. They're collecting proof that they lived. An experience today is worth more than a promise tomorrow. Because tomorrow, frankly, looks suspicious.

## WHAT BUSINESSES MUST UNLEARN

Many brands still communicate using the grammar of deferred living:

- Buy now, enjoy later
- Premium equals quality

Instead, Gen Z responds to flexibility over certainty, transparency over authority, design and values over legacy and immediate relevance over long-term promises

To GenZers long commitment sounds like an emotional hostage situation. They want brands that sound human, not parental. They're not disloyal. They're just not sentimental about corporations.

Here's the uncomfortable part.

Gen Z has watched us do everything "right" from saving diligently to compromising joy, deferring dreams and still facing burnout, anxiety, and regret. So they've made a quiet decision that if the world is uncertain, they will not postpone happiness. That's not carelessness. That's courage.

If we want Gen Z to save for tomorrow, we must first make tomorrow feel worth saving for. Until then, they will keep living loudly, loving briefly, upgrading often and choosing more life than work in the work-life balance.

And maybe, just maybe, they're not wrong. **BT**

ILLUSTRATION BY RAJ VERMA

